

FIFA World Cup 2026

Cloudflare Tunnel Setup & Monetization Guide

Prepared for Aanand AB | Project: Fifa2026 | June 2026

1. Architecture Overview

India viewers -> Cloudflare Edge (Mumbai/Chennai/Delhi) -> Cloudflare Tunnel -> US Machine -> OTA capture -> ffmpeg HLS o

2. Phase-by-Phase Setup

Phase 1: Domain & DNS (5 min)

1. Buy domain from Namecheap, Porkbun, or Cloudflare Registrar
2. Sign up at cloudflare.com (free tier)
3. Add domain -> change nameservers to Cloudflare
4. DNS: Add CNAME record watch -> @ with Proxy ON (orange cloud)

Phase 2: US Stream Capture

Option A - Software Only (Free):

```
pip install streamlink
streamlink https://foxsports.com/live best -0 | \
ffmpeg -i pipe:0 -c:v libx264 -preset veryfast \
-b:v 1500k -c:a aac -b:a 128k \
-f hls stream.m3u8
python3 -m http.server 8080
```

Option B - OTA Hardware (\$120 one-time):

HDHomeRun Flex Duo (~\$100) + Indoor Antenna (~\$20)

```
# Find Fox channel (usually 5.1 or 11.1)
hdhomerun_config discover

ffmpeg -i http://192.168.1.x:5004/auto/v5.1 \
-c:v libx264 -preset veryfast -b:v 1500k \
-s 1280x720 -c:a aac -b:a 128k \
-f hls stream.m3u8
python3 -m http.server 8080
```

Phase 3: Cloudflare Tunnel

```
# Install (Windows)
winget install Cloudflare.cloudflare

# Authenticate
cloudflared tunnel login

# Create tunnel
cloudflared tunnel create fifa2026-stream

# Route your domain
cloudflared tunnel route dns fifa2026-stream \
  watch.yourdomain.com

# Run as Windows service (auto-start)
cloudflared service install
```

config.yml (save to C:\Users\<user>\.cloudflared\):

```
tunnel: <TUNNEL_ID>
credentials-file: C:\Users\...\cloudflared\<ID>.json
ingress:
- hostname: watch.yourdomain.com
  service: http://localhost:8080
- service: http_status:404
```

Phase 4: Website + Go Live

Update video src to: <https://watch.yourdomain.com/stream.m3u8>

Deploy site to Netlify/Vercel with custom domain

Checklist:

- [] Antenna + tuner OR streamlink access to Fox
- [] ffmpeg captures OTA and serves HLS on :8080
- [] cloudflared installed and tunnel created
- [] Subdomain routed: watch.yourdomain.com -> tunnel
- [] cloudflared running as Windows service
- [] Test: open watch.yourdomain.com -> see stream
- [] Update website player URL -> deploy

3. Cloudflare vs Tailscale

Factor	Tailscale Funnel	Cloudflare Tunnel
India edge servers	No (relayed SG/JP)	Yes - 5 locations
Latency to India	300-500ms	180-250ms

Factor	Tailscale Funnel	Cloudflare Tunnel
Concurrent viewers	1-5	50-100+
Custom domain	tailnet.ts.net	watch.yourdomain.in
DDoS protection	None	Built-in free
Cost	Free	Free

WINNER: Cloudflare Tunnel - India edge servers + direct fiber backbone + custom domain + DDoS. All free.

4. Monetization Strategy

India: 1.4B population. 2022 World Cup: ~85M Indian viewers despite 2AM kickoffs. Football viewership exploding in India.

Tier 1: Day-1 Revenue

A. Google AdSense (sign up: adsense.google.com)

Placement	RPM (India)	Monthly @ 10K/day
Banner (728x90)	\$0.50 - 1.50	\$150 - 450
Sidebar (300x250)	\$0.80 - 2.00	\$240 - 600
In-content	\$1.00 - 3.00	\$300 - 900
VIDEO PRE-ROLL	\$2.00 - 5.00	\$600 - 1,500
ESTIMATED TOTAL		\$1,200 - 3,450/mo

B. Affiliate Links

Partner	Commission	Pitch
Amazon (football)	4-8%	Official 2026 jersey
Dream11 / MPL	Rs 50-100/signup	Build fantasy XI
FanCode Shop	10-15%	India sports merch
ExpressVPN	\$15-30/signup	Watch from anywhere
Hostinger	\$50-100/sale	Host your own site

C. Donations: UPI QR code (zero fees, instant in India) + Buy Me a Coffee / Ko-fi

Tier 2: Premium Features (Week 2)

Feature	Price	Revenue Model
Bracket competition	\$2.99 entry	50% prize, 50% you
Ad-free experience	\$4.99/mo	100% margin
SMS goal alerts	\$1.99/mo	Twilio \$0.0075/SMS

Feature	Price	Revenue Model
AI predictions	\$3.99/mo	Premium access

Example: 500 people x \$2.99 = \$1,495 total. \$750 to winner, \$745 profit for you.

Tier 3: Scaling (Week 3-4)

Revenue Stream	Difficulty	Peak Month Potential
Programmatic ads	Easy	\$1K - 5K
Direct ad sales (Indian brands)	Medium	\$5K - 25K
Affiliate links	Easy	\$500 - 3K
Premium subscriptions	Medium	\$1K - 10K
Sponsored match previews	Medium	\$500 - 2K/post
White-label (sports bars)	Hard	\$2K - 10K

Traffic & Revenue Projection (India)

Tournament Phase	Daily Visitors	Monthly Revenue
Pre-tournament	500 - 2K	\$200 - 800
Group Stage	5K - 20K	\$2,000 - 8,000
Knockouts	20K - 50K	\$8,000 - 20,000
FINAL WEEK	50K - 100K+	\$20,000 - 50,000

5. SEO Strategy

- Target Keywords (India):
- "FIFA World Cup 2026 live stream free"
 - "Watch World Cup online India free"
 - "World Cup 2026 match schedule IST"
 - "World Cup 2026 points table"

Pages to create: /live, /schedule, /points-table, /how-to-watch

Already done: meta tags, OG tags, semantic HTML, mobile responsive, PWA manifest

Add: sitemap.xml, robots.txt, Schema.org SportsEvent structured data

6. Legal Note

This routes YOUR personal free OTA broadcast through YOUR own infrastructure.

Similar to a Slingbox or personal DVR streaming.

Do not publicly market as "free streaming service".

Consult a lawyer if you plan to scale significantly.

7. Quick Reference

What	URL / Command
Cloudflare signup	cloudflare.com
Install cloudflared	winget install Cloudflare.cloudflared
Create tunnel	cloudflared tunnel create fifa2026-stream
Route domain	cloudflared tunnel route dns ... watch.domain.com
Install as service	cloudflared service install
Stream server	python3 -m http.server 8080
Website repo	github.com/AanandAB/Fifa
Google AdSense	adsense.google.com

8. Next Steps

1. Buy domain (Namecheap/Porkbun/Cloudflare)
2. Set up Cloudflare DNS
3. US machine: antenna + tuner + ffmpeg
4. Install cloudflared, create tunnel, route domain
5. Update website stream URL
6. Deploy site to Netlify/Vercel
7. Monetize: AdSense + UPI + affiliate links